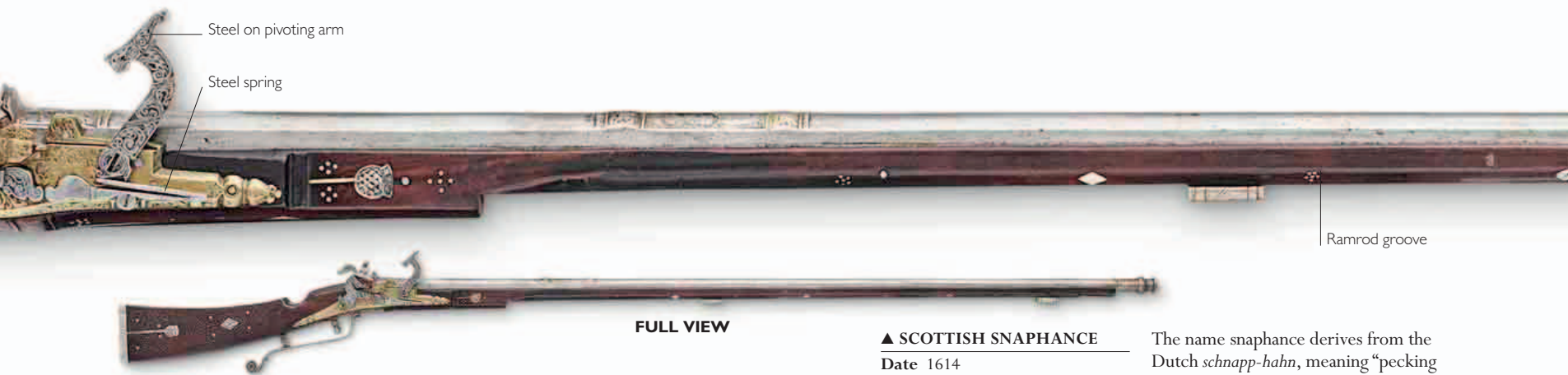




Steel on pivoting arm

Steel spring

Ramrod groove

FULL VIEW

▲ SCOTTISH SNAPHANCE

Date 1614

Origin Scotland

Barrel 38in (96.5cm)

Caliber .45in (11.5mm)

The name snaphance derives from the Dutch *schnapp-hahn*, meaning “pecking hen,” which the mechanism was thought to resemble. It was the first attempt to simplify the wheel-lock’s method of striking sparks from a piece of iron pyrite. This example is attributed to gunsmith Alison of Dundee, Scotland. It was a gift from King James VI of Scotland (and eventually of England) to Louis XIII of France.



Barrel-fixing pin

Ramrod

FULL VIEW

▲ ITALIAN WHEEL-LOCK

Date c.1630

Origin Italy

Barrel 31½in (80cm)

Caliber .45in (11.5mm)

By the 17th century, the northern cities of Brescia and Bologna had long been the centers for the fabrication of wheel-lock guns in Italy. This example is by Lazarino Cominazzo of Brescia, who was better known for his pistols.



Iron pyrite

Cocking ring works as a handle to help the shooter move the dog

Bone inlay

Spring holds dog firmly against wheel when gun is fired

Ramrod

FULL VIEW

▲ GERMAN WHEEL-LOCK

Date c.1640

Origin Germany

Barrel 34in (86.4cm)

Caliber .65in (16.5mm)

The wheel-lock mechanism appeared in both Italy and Germany in around 1500, and soon firearms using this revolutionary new ignition system were being made and used throughout much of Europe. This example has its serrated wheel mounted externally, to make it easier to clean, although the rest of the lock-work is protected within the stock behind the lock plate.